

Understanding the business, users and design problem

A compact context document for making informed UX, content and information-architecture decisions.

A USEFUL MENTAL MODEL

ITW ARC sits between legal thinking and the business of sports, media and entertainment. The website has to make complex expertise understandable, credible and relevant to people with very different levels of legal knowledge.

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What this website needs to accomplish

- Help prospective clients quickly understand what ITW ARC is and where it can help.
- Build confidence through relevant expertise, people, experience and project evidence.
- Explain legal and commercial services without assuming every visitor understands legal language.
- Support serious business evaluation rather than product browsing or transactions.
- Create a clear path from curiosity or verification to a meaningful conversation with the team.
- Remain scalable for future insights, news and thought leadership if content ownership is established.

The central design challenge

A league executive, an in-house lawyer, a sponsor, a potential hire and someone who has only seen the ITW ARC name in a news article can all land on the same website. The experience should not force all of them to think like lawyers before they can understand the value.

01 What ITW ARC does

ITW ARC is the advisory, regulatory and compliance team within ITW Universe, focused on Sports, Media & Entertainment. A major use case is helping sports leagues set up, grow and operate with stronger legal and commercial foundations.

The work is not only about drafting documents. It can sit across league setup, partner selection, rights allocation, revenue structures, media deals, contracts, compliance, governance and disputes.

Core services in business language

EOI + ITT / tender documents

Helps a league invite, evaluate and select franchise owners, sponsors or other partners through a structured bidding process.

Franchise agreements

Defines the relationship between the league and team owners: rights, responsibilities, revenue, IP usage, commitments and protections.

Broadcast agreements

Structures television, digital and OTT media-rights relationships, including commercial and legal terms around distribution.

Production agreements

Covers the companies responsible for creating and delivering broadcast or event production.

Vendor agreements

Covers the wider set of partners and service providers required to operate a league or large sports property.

Broader advisory support

Can include governance, regulatory/compliance work, sponsorship contracting, rights structures, commercial frameworks and dispute advisory.

Why the legal work matters to the business

- Better-defined rights can reduce confusion between leagues, franchises, sponsors and media partners.
- Clear tender and agreement structures can support commercial confidence and long-term stability.
- Compliance and governance reduce avoidable delays, disputes and regulatory problems.
- Legal decisions can affect revenue, rights protection, partner relationships and execution quality.

DESIGN CONSIDERATION

A service name alone is rarely enough. Consider whether a visitor can understand when the service becomes useful, what problem it addresses and what business outcome it supports.

02 Core audiences — business decision-makers

Audience thinking should go beyond industry labels. The important difference is why someone arrived, how much they already know, what they are responsible for and what evidence they need before moving forward.

League organizers & rights holders

Founders, league management, federation leaders, commercial heads and senior decision-makers.

WHY THEY MAY COME

Launching or scaling a league, changing franchise structure, selling rights, bringing in partners, or handling a legal/commercial issue.

WHAT THEY LOOK FOR

League-specific expertise, relevant services, comparable experience, risk awareness and the people they would work with.

WHAT THEY MAY DO

Scan positioning, explore services, inspect projects and senior team credibility, then contact or share internally.

HOW OFTEN

Usually need-based; repeat visits are likely during evaluation, procurement or an active project.

Franchises, sponsors & commercial partners

Team owners, brand leaders, partnership teams, agencies and commercial stakeholders.

WHY THEY MAY COME	Evaluating a league relationship, sponsorship structure, rights package, agreement or partnership opportunity.
WHAT THEY LOOK FOR	Whether ARC understands rights, obligations, IP, deliverables, commercial realities and dispute risk.
WHAT THEY MAY DO	Enter through a relevant service, project or referral, then verify expertise before a meeting or negotiation.
HOW OFTEN	Occasional; more frequent when negotiations, renewals or new engagements are active.

A USEFUL DISTINCTION

The buyer of legal/advisory work may not be the same person who evaluates it. A senior business leader may care about commercial confidence and speed; an in-house lawyer may inspect scope, team credentials and technical depth.

03 Core audiences — specialist evaluators and wider visitors

Broadcasters, OTT & media businesses

Media-rights teams, legal/commercial teams, production stakeholders and platform decision-makers.

WHY THEY MAY COME	A rights negotiation, production arrangement, content-delivery agreement or media partnership.
WHAT THEY LOOK FOR	Media-rights experience, contracting depth, relevant people and evidence of large-scale sports/media work.
WHAT THEY MAY DO	Go deeper into expertise and team credentials; they may arrive directly on a service or project page.
HOW OFTEN	Low-frequency but high-intent visits around deals, renewals and due diligence.

Legal, compliance & procurement evaluators

In-house counsel, compliance, procurement and advisors validating a specialist partner.

WHY THEY MAY COME	Shortlisting, due diligence, internal recommendation, credential checks or claim validation before engagement.
WHAT THEY LOOK FOR	Exact capability, seniority, team depth, relevant experience, industry exposure and trustworthy evidence.
WHAT THEY MAY DO	Read more carefully, compare details, revisit pages and share information with other decision-makers.
HOW OFTEN	Repeat usage is more likely during evaluation and approval cycles.

Other visitors worth designing for

Strategic partners & investors

May be checking governance maturity, business credibility, capability and how ARC fits into the wider sports ecosystem.

Potential hires

Usually look for the work ARC handles, team quality, senior expertise, reputation and what makes the practice distinctive.

Media / researchers / industry peers

May arrive through a project, award, legal topic, team member or industry story and want quick context and credible facts.

First-time / low-context visitors

May not know whether ARC is a law firm, advisory practice, ITW division or what the service names mean. Their first need is orientation.

04 Why people arrive and what they try to do

Until real analytics exist, entry sources should be treated as hypotheses to design for and later validate.

Possible entry points

- A referral from an ITW relationship, league stakeholder, lawyer, partner or colleague.
- A Google search around a sports-law, league, media-rights or compliance problem.
- LinkedIn, a news article, award mention, team profile or project announcement.
- A proposal, email, presentation or meeting where the person wants to verify ARC afterwards.
- Navigation from another ITW property or a direct brand search.

- A job search or professional research rather than a sales requirement.

Underlying jobs on the website

Orient

Understand what ARC is, how it relates to ITW Universe and whether it is relevant.

Match

Connect a business situation to the right expertise without needing perfect legal vocabulary.

Verify

Check comparable work, team experience and whether the practice appears credible enough for the requirement.

Assess risk

Decide whether ARC seems capable of handling important, high-value or sensitive work.

Share internally

Send a relevant page to another stakeholder involved in evaluation or approval.

Start a conversation

Contact the team once enough relevance and confidence have been established.

Typical journey patterns to think through

Referral → Home/About → relevant service → project proof → team → contact.

Search → specific expertise/insight → related proof → broader ARC context → contact.

Project/news mention → project or Home → who are they? → team/services → exit or enquiry.

Due diligence → About/team/projects → revisit → share internally → contact.

Low-context visit → simple explanation → problem/service examples → proof → deeper legal detail if needed.

LOW-CONTEXT VISITOR TEST

Can someone answer these in under a minute: What is ITW ARC? Who does it help? What problems does it work on? Why should I trust it? Where do I go next?

05 Content and information architecture thinking

A practical starting structure includes Home, About, Services, Industries/Expertise, Projects & Case Studies, Leadership/Legal Team, News/Insights and Contact. The useful design question is what each area must help the visitor understand or decide.

Home	Can someone understand ARC, its relevance and strongest proof quickly?
About	How much ITW Universe context is useful before it distracts from ARC itself?
Services	Should people explore by legal service name, business problem, project stage, stakeholder type or a combination?
Industries / Expertise	Does this create a distinct mental model beyond Services, or does it duplicate information?
Projects & Case Studies	Which evidence demonstrates scope, complexity and impact while respecting confidentiality and approval limits?
Team	What expertise should be scannable before someone chooses to read a full profile?
Insights	Who owns it, how often can it be maintained and what makes it genuinely useful enough to revisit?
Contact	What information is needed to route an enquiry without encouraging sensitive legal details too early?

Language and progressive disclosure

- Lead with the business situation or outcome before introducing dense legal terminology.
- Give short explanations for specialist terms where a non-lawyer is likely to encounter them.
- Allow experienced visitors to go deeper into exact capability without forcing everyone through long educational content.
- Use examples to make abstract services concrete, but avoid claims or promises that depend on legal outcomes.
- Treat case studies, awards and project claims as trust assets that need public-use approval.

CMS and content ownership

The first version can work as an informational corporate site, but Insights/News changes the operating model. If regular publishing is expected, content ownership, approval, update frequency and CMS access should be clarified before the experience is designed around fresh content.

06 Experience and visual direction

The intended experience is premium, corporate and modern while still belonging to the sports/media world. Too traditional can feel generic and dated; too energetic can weaken legal credibility.

Authority without stiffness

Use hierarchy, typography, spacing and evidence to create seriousness without copying old law-firm patterns.

Sports without spectacle

Let the industry show through relevant content, imagery and motion rather than a fan-site or sports-news aesthetic.

Premium without emptiness

Whitespace and animation only help when users can still find meaningful information and proof quickly.

Modern without gimmicks

Motion should support storytelling and hierarchy rather than become the reason the website feels “premium”.

Credibility through specifics

Relevant project context, team expertise and clearly explained capability are stronger than generic “trusted expert” claims.

Responsive by thinking, not shrinking

Mobile needs deliberate content priority and navigation, not a compressed desktop layout.

Baseline experience considerations

- Responsive across desktop, tablet and mobile.
- Fast loading with restrained media and animation choices.
- SEO-friendly structure and clear page intent.
- Cross-browser reliability and maintainable component patterns.
- Analytics that can reveal entry pages, high-interest content, return behaviour and enquiry paths.
- Accessibility as a baseline quality requirement, not a decorative feature.

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

The site should work for two reading modes at once: quick confidence-building for senior decision-makers and deeper validation for people who need to inspect the details.

07 Questions to resolve before high-fidelity design

These questions are likely to change the structure and content more than visual styling will.

Audience priority

Which audience is commercially most important, and which must understand the site fastest?

Top use cases	What are the 3-5 most common situations that cause someone to approach ARC today?
Service priority	Which services are core, which are supporting, and which should not be promoted publicly?
Proof permission	Which names, logos, outcomes, numbers and project details are approved for public use?
Positioning	How should ARC describe its relationship with ITW Universe so visitors do not misunderstand what it is?
Conversion	What is the preferred next step: consultation, email, form, senior contact or another route?
Lead handling	Who receives enquiries, what information helps before the first call, and what should not be collected?
Content ownership	Who maintains insights/news, how often, and how are outdated legal or industry updates handled?
Search & discovery	What words do real clients use for these problems: legal terminology or business situations?
Success metrics	What signals matter: qualified enquiries, consultation requests, case-study engagement, returning visitors or something else?
Brand system	Which ITW brand elements are fixed, and where can ARC develop its own identity?
Scalability	What could be added in the next 12-24 months: new services, markets, publications, events, careers or resources?

What a strong design exploration should demonstrate

- A clear view of audience priority and the different reasons people arrive.
- A sitemap/content model with reasoning, not just a list of conventional corporate pages.
- Key journeys from different entry points, including people unfamiliar with legal terminology.
- Wireframes that show information priority, trust-building and progression toward contact.
- A thoughtful balance between plain language and professional/legal depth.
- A visual direction credible for high-value advisory work and relevant to sports/media.
- Responsive thinking and realistic consideration of what content can actually be maintained.

KEEP ASKING THIS THROUGHOUT THE DESIGN

What does the visitor need to understand, trust or decide at this point — and what is the minimum information that helps them move forward?
